

Paper 2: Early Elizabethan England, 1558-88

"What was life like during the Elizabethan Golden Age?"

MASTERY PACK: KEY TOPIC 3: ELIZABETHAN SOCIETY IN THE AGE OF EXPLORATION, 1558-88

Operative / Student Name: _____

Target: Total Recall of 120 Crucial Questions



⚡ Interactive Recall Quiz & Scratch-Off Vault

Scan with your phone to launch Instant-Feedback Recall Quiz (#practice-mode) & tap-to-reveal self-marking solutions.

the-history-revision-hub.netlify.app/units/eee/mastery_pack_KT3.html#practice-mode

RESTRICTED ACCESS - MASTER YOUR MEMORY

How to Hack Your Memory

(Rules of Engagement)

1. Never Just Read

Reading the answers feels like learning, but it's an illusion. You must force your brain to struggle to find the answer. The struggle is what builds memory pathways.

2. Cover, Recall, Check

Cover the answer sheet. Write your answer down in the notes section (or say it out loud). Only then are you allowed to check 'The Vault'.

3. Track Your Threat Level

Use the R-A-G (Red, Amber, Green) checkboxes next to every question after you attempt it.

- ☐ **Green:** I nailed it instantly.
- ☐ **Amber:** I got it, but I had to think hard.
- ☐ **Red:** My mind went blank. (Revisit these tomorrow).

4. The Interrogation (Homework Protocol)

True mastery requires testing under pressure. Hand 'The Vault' (answers) to your parent or guardian. They will test you on 20 random questions. They hold the score; they hold the signature.

5. The 3-Star Parent Effort Rubric

When authenticating your spaced retrieval practice on the final Mastery Tracker, your parent or guardian will evaluate your effort using the following criteria:

-  **3 Stars (Full Mastery):** Completed under strict exam conditions without glancing at notes or the Knowledge Vault. Total independent recall.
-  **2 Stars (Consolidating):** Required 1–2 hints from the Knowledge Vault, but demonstrated sound foundational understanding.
-  **1 Star (Needs Intervention):** Rushed, mind went blank, or completed with notes open. Target facts must be hunted down and re-tested tomorrow.

KT3.1: Education and leisure

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
1	What intellectual movement acted as a catalyst for educational reform in Elizabethan England?	☐	☐	☐	
2	Which prominent Humanist scholar was Queen Elizabeth's personal tutor?	☐	☐	☐	
3	What invention significantly helped increase literacy by making books cheaper?	☐	☐	☐	
4	What type of local school provided basic education for young boys and some girls?	☐	☐	☐	
5	What wooden object covered in a transparent layer was used to teach children the alphabet?	☐	☐	☐	
6	What type of school did the sons of the gentry and merchants attend from age seven?	☐	☐	☐	
7	Which language dominated the curriculum of the Elizabethan Grammar school?	☐	☐	☐	
8	Roughly what percentage of men, and what percentage of women, were literate by 1603?	☐	☐	☐	
9	Name one exclusive sport played only by the nobility.	☐	☐	☐	
10	What violently aggressive sport was played by the lower classes between neighbouring villages?	☐	☐	☐	
11	Give two examples of 'cruel sports' popular in Elizabethan England.	☐	☐	☐	
12	What was the Queen's personal attitude towards bear-baiting?	☐	☐	☐	
13	What type of plays did Elizabeth ban in the 1570s to avoid religious conflict?	☐	☐	☐	
14	Name one famous pioneering Elizabethan playwright other than Shakespeare.	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
15	In what year was the first purpose-built theatre (The Theatre) constructed?	☐	☐	☐	
16	What was the nickname given to the poorest theatre-goers who stood in the open-air pit?	☐	☐	☐	
17	Which religious group furiously opposed the theatre, believing it was the work of the devil?	☐	☐	☐	
18	What 1572 law meant actors could be whipped if they didn't have a noble license?	☐	☐	☐	
19	Name one famous acting company sponsored by powerful nobility to protect them from the law.	☐	☐	☐	
20	Why did the location of the theatres (outside the City walls) exacerbate opposition from authorities?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

Score: _____ / 20

Parent/Guardian Authentication (Signature): _____

Date: _____

KT3.1: Education and leisure

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
21	What basic elementary schools taught reading, writing, and arithmetic to young children?	☐	☐	☐	
22	Which fee-paying secondary schools taught Latin, Greek, and rhetoric to middle-class boys?	☐	☐	☐	
23	Did girls attend grammar schools or universities in Elizabethan England?	☐	☐	☐	
24	Which two universities existed in England during Elizabeth's reign?	☐	☐	☐	
25	What violent blood sports were popular with both ordinary people and the nobility?	☐	☐	☐	
26	What name was given to theatergoers who paid 1 penny to stand in the unroofed pit?	☐	☐	☐	
27	Who built London's first permanent public playhouse, 'The Theatre', in 1576?	☐	☐	☐	
28	Which famous Southwark playhouse was built by Shakespeare's company in 1599?	☐	☐	☐	
29	Why did the Puritan-led City of London Corporation oppose theatres?	☐	☐	☐	
30	What aristocratic playing company was patronized by Elizabeth's favourite Robert Dudley?	☐	☐	☐	
31	What happened to the population of England between 1551 and 1601?	☐	☐	☐	
32	What economic problem was caused by demand for food outstripping supply?	☐	☐	☐	
33	What agricultural practice involved landlords fencing off common fields?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
34	Why did landlords prefer breeding sheep over traditional crop farming?	☐	☐	☐	
35	What happened to unemployed rural workers after they were evicted due to enclosure?	☐	☐	☐	
36	Which major European port city placed a trade embargo on English cloth, causing mass unemployment?	☐	☐	☐	
37	What term was used to describe the 'deserving' poor (the sick, elderly, and orphans)?	☐	☐	☐	
38	What term was used to describe the 'undeserving' poor who were physically capable of working?	☐	☐	☐	
39	What was the name given to a homeless, unemployed person who wandered from town to town?	☐	☐	☐	
40	Give two reasons why the authorities were terrified of vagabonds.	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

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KT3.2: The Problem of Poverty

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
41	Who wrote a famous pamphlet warning the public about the tricks used by vagabonds?	☐	☐	☐	
42	What was a 'Counterfeit Crank'?	☐	☐	☐	
43	What physical punishment was dictated by the 1572 Vagabonds Act for a first-time offence?	☐	☐	☐	
44	Under the 1572 Act, what was the punishment for being caught as a vagabond a third time?	☐	☐	☐	
45	What highly significant financial system did the 1572 Act introduce to help the impotent poor?	☐	☐	☐	
46	Who was responsible for collecting the Poor Rate in local areas?	☐	☐	☐	
47	What major economic reality did the 1576 Poor Relief Act finally recognise?	☐	☐	☐	
48	What did the 1576 Act order JPs to provide for the genuinely unemployed?	☐	☐	☐	
49	What institutions were created under the 1576 Act to punish those who refused to work?	☐	☐	☐	
50	Why did the government ultimately transition from brutal punishment to national poor relief?	☐	☐	☐	
51	Approximately what was England's population in 1558 compared to 1603?	☐	☐	☐	
52	What term describes fencing off open peasant farmland into enclosed fields for sheep grazing?	☐	☐	☐	
53	Why did landowners prefer sheep farming to arable farming with grain crops?	☐	☐	☐	
54	What economic term describes continuous rising prices of food and goods?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
55	What catastrophic weather disaster caused food shortages and rocketing grain prices in the 1590s?	☐	☐	☐	
56	What term described the elderly, orphans, and disabled poor who were unable to work?	☐	☐	☐	
57	What term described fit, healthy beggars who were assumed to be deliberately lazy?	☐	☐	☐	
58	What punishment was imposed on sturdy beggars under the 1572 Vagabonds Act?	☐	☐	☐	
59	What institutions were created by the 1576 Poor Act to punish idle beggars with hard labour?	☐	☐	☐	
60	What local parish tax paid for the relief of the impotent poor?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

Score: _____ / 20

Parent/Guardian Authentication (Signature): _____

Date: _____

KT3.3: Exploration and voyages of discovery

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
61	What traditional English trade market collapsed, prompting the search for new global markets?	☐	☐	☐	
62	Name an essential navigational instrument that used the stars to determine latitude.	☐	☐	☐	
63	What type of new, highly manoeuvrable warship was developed by the English?	☐	☐	☐	
64	What term describes a sailor officially licensed by the Queen to attack Spanish ships?	☐	☐	☐	
65	Between which years did Francis Drake circumnavigate the globe?	☐	☐	☐	
66	What area of North America (modern-day California) did Drake claim for Elizabeth?	☐	☐	☐	
67	Roughly how much Spanish treasure did Drake bring back to England?	☐	☐	☐	
68	On which ship was Francis Drake knighted by Queen Elizabeth?	☐	☐	☐	
69	Which English nobleman was given a royal charter in 1584 to colonise North America?	☐	☐	☐	
70	What name was given to the new territory in honour of Elizabeth?	☐	☐	☐	
71	On which specific island off the coast of North America did the colonists land?	☐	☐	☐	
72	What was the name of the flagship that hit a sandbank, ruining the colony's food and seeds?	☐	☐	☐	
73	Name one of the aggressive military leaders of the 1585 expedition who caused conflict.	☐	☐	☐	
74	Which Native American Chief turned against the English and attacked the colony?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
75	Why did Native Americans turn against the English settlers?	☐	☐	☐	
76	In what year was the second attempt to establish a colony (which included women and children) launched?	☐	☐	☐	
77	Who was the leader of the 1587 expedition who returned to England for supplies?	☐	☐	☐	
78	Why couldn't supply ships return to Virginia in 1588?	☐	☐	☐	
79	How long were the 1587 colonists left without any supplies or communication?	☐	☐	☐	
80	What is the famous nickname given to the 1587 settlement that vanished without a trace?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

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Date: _____

KT3.3: Exploration and voyages of discovery

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
81	Which navigation instrument measured the angle of the sun and stars to calculate latitude?	☐	☐	☐	
82	What magnetic Chinese navigational tool allowed Elizabethan ships to steer accurate compass headings?	☐	☐	☐	
83	What new 1569 map projection allowed navigators to plot straight sailing courses across oceans?	☐	☐	☐	
84	Which valuable Asian commodities drove European explorers to find sea routes to the East?	☐	☐	☐	
85	What was the original name of Sir Francis Drake's flagship before he renamed it *Golden Hind*?	☐	☐	☐	
86	Through which notoriously dangerous strait at the tip of South America did Drake sail in 1578?	☐	☐	☐	
87	What name did Drake give to the Californian coast he claimed for Queen Elizabeth in 1579?	☐	☐	☐	
88	In which Indonesian spice islands did Drake trade with the Sultan of Ternate for cloves?	☐	☐	☐	
89	How long did Drake's circumnavigation take from departure to return?	☐	☐	☐	
90	What percentage profit did Drake's voyage generate for Queen Elizabeth and his investors?	☐	☐	☐	
91	In what year did Queen Elizabeth grant Walter Raleigh a Royal Charter?	☐	☐	☐	
92	What traditional European English trade market had collapsed, encouraging New World expansion?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
93	What name was given to the new territory in North America in honour of Elizabeth?	☐	☐	☐	
94	Did Walter Raleigh personally lead the expeditions to North America?	☐	☐	☐	
95	Name the two Native Americans brought to England in 1584 to help with translation.	☐	☐	☐	
96	Strategically, what did the English hope to use a colony in Virginia for?	☐	☐	☐	
97	On which specific island was the colony established?	☐	☐	☐	
98	Who was the aggressive military governor of the 1585 expedition?	☐	☐	☐	
99	Who was the brilliant mathematician and mapmaker on the 1585 expedition?	☐	☐	☐	
100	What was the name of the flagship that hit a sandbank, ruining the food and seeds?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

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KT3.4: Raleigh and Virginia

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
101	Why were the 1585 colonists poorly suited to building a settlement?	☐	☐	☐	
102	Which Native American Chief turned against the English and was killed by Ralph Lane?	☐	☐	☐	
103	Apart from violence, what unwittingly killed many Native Americans?	☐	☐	☐	
104	Who rescued the surviving 1585 colonists and took them back to England?	☐	☐	☐	
105	How did the demographics of the 1587 expedition differ from the 1585 expedition?	☐	☐	☐	
106	Who was the leader of the 1587 expedition?	☐	☐	☐	
107	Why were the Native Americans immediately hostile to the 1587 colonists?	☐	☐	☐	
108	Why was John White unable to return to Virginia with supplies in 1588?	☐	☐	☐	
109	How long was John White stranded in England?	☐	☐	☐	
110	What single word was found carved into a post when White finally returned?	☐	☐	☐	
111	Which Elizabethan courtier and explorer was granted a royal patent to colonise Virginia in 1584?	☐	☐	☐	
112	Why was the new North American territory named 'Virginia' by the English?	☐	☐	☐	
113	Did Sir Walter Raleigh ever travel to Virginia himself?	☐	☐	☐	
114	On which barrier island off modern North Carolina was the first English colony established in 1585?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
115	Which two Native Americans were brought back to London in 1584 to advise the English?	☐	☐	☐	
116	Who was appointed governor of the first 1585 Roanoke settlement?	☐	☐	☐	
117	What catastrophic accident happened to the flagship *Tiger* that destroyed the colonists' food seeds?	☐	☐	☐	
118	Who commanded the English relief fleet that evacuated the starving colonists in 1586?	☐	☐	☐	
119	Who was appointed governor of the second 1587 settlement ("The Lost Colony")?	☐	☐	☐	
120	What single word carved on a wooden palisade post was found when John White returned in 1590?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

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THE VAULT

Restricted Access: Answer Keys

KT3.1: Education and leisure

1. Humanism
2. Roger Ascham
3. The printing press
4. A Petty School / Dame School
5. A hornbook
6. A Grammar School
7. Latin
8. 30% of men, 10% of women
9. Real tennis / Hawking / Fencing / Hunting on horseback
10. Mob football
11. Bear-baiting and Bull-baiting
12. She loved it and frequently ordered private exhibitions
13. Religious mystery plays
14. Christopher Marlowe
15. 1576
16. Groundlings
17. The Puritans
18. The Vagabonds Act
19. The Lord Chamberlain's Men / The Earl of Leicester's Men
20. They attracted crime/prostitutes beyond the Mayor's control and spread the Bubonic Plague
21. Petty schools (or Dame schools)
22. Grammar schools
23. No (girls were educated at home in domestic needlework and household management)
24. Oxford and Cambridge
25. Bear-baiting and cock-fighting
26. Groundlings (or penny stinkards)
27. James Burbage
28. The Globe Theatre
29. They believed plays spread plague, promoted sin and immorality, and lured apprentices from work
30. The Earl of Leicester's Men



KT3.1: Education and leisure

31. It grew rapidly from roughly 3 million to over 4 million
32. Rapid inflation (prices rising much faster than wages)
33. Enclosure
34. The European wool trade was more lucrative and it required fewer workers to pay
35. They migrated to towns and cities looking for work, becoming vagrants/vagabonds
36. Antwerp
37. The Impotent Poor
38. The Able-bodied Poor
39. A vagabond or vagrant
40. They believed they spread disease, committed crimes, and could start a rebellion

KT3.2: The Problem of Poverty

41. Thomas Harman
42. A beggar who faked epileptic fits using soap to get sympathy money
43. Being whipped and having a hole burned through the right ear
44. Execution
45. The national Poor Rate
46. Justices of the Peace / JPs
47. That some able-bodied people wanted to work but simply couldn't find employment
48. Raw materials, like wool and hemp, to work with and sell
49. Houses of Correction
50. They realised the sheer scale of the crisis could lead to starvation and a massive peasant rebellion if left ignored
51. Roughly 3 million in 1558, rising to over 4 million by 1603 (35% increase)
52. Enclosure
53. Wool was highly profitable and sheep required far fewer agricultural labourers
54. Inflation (price rise)
55. Consecutive bad harvests
56. The Impotent Poor (or Deserving Poor)
57. The Sturdy Beggars (or Idle/Undeserving Poor)
58. Whipped and burned through the gristle of the right ear with a hot iron
59. Houses of Correction (Bridewells)
60. The Poor Rate

KT3.3: Exploration and voyages of discovery

61. The Antwerp cloth market
62. The Astrolabe / Quadrant
63. The Galleon
64. Privateer
65. 1577–1580
66. Nova Albion
67. £400,000
68. The Golden Hind
69. Sir Walter Raleigh
70. Virginia
71. Roanoke Island
72. The Tiger
73. Ralph Lane (or Richard Grenville)
74. Chief Wingina
75. English demands for food, aggressive behaviour, and the spread of deadly European diseases
76. 1587
77. John White
78. All English ships were requisitioned to fight the Spanish Armada
79. Three years
80. The 'Lost Colony'
81. The Astrolabe (or Quadrant)
82. The Magnetic Compass
83. The Mercator Projection
84. Spices (pepper, cloves, nutmeg) and silk
85. *The Pelican*
86. The Strait of Magellan
87. Nova Albion (New Britain)
88. The Moluccas (Spice Islands)
89. Nearly three years (December 1577 – September 1580)
90. 4,700% profit



KT3.3: Exploration and voyages of discovery

- 91. 1584
- 92. The Antwerp cloth market
- 93. Virginia
- 94. No, Elizabeth refused to let him leave court
- 95. Manteo and Wanchese
- 96. As a hidden base for privateers to attack Spanish treasure ships
- 97. Roanoke Island
- 98. Ralph Lane
- 99. Thomas Harriot
- 100. The Tiger

KT3.4: Raleigh and Virginia

- 101. They were mostly soldiers and gentlemen with no farming skills
- 102. Chief Wingina
- 103. European diseases to which they had no immunity
- 104. Francis Drake
- 105. It included families, women, and children with farming skills
- 106. John White
- 107. Because of the violence and murders committed by Ralph Lane's men in 1585
- 108. Elizabeth banned all ships from leaving England to fight the Spanish Armada
- 109. Three years / until 1590
- 110. CROATOAN
- 111. Sir Walter Raleigh
- 112. In honour of Elizabeth I, the "Virgin Queen"
- 113. No (he organized and funded the expeditions from England)
- 114. Roanoke Island
- 115. Manteo and Wanchese
- 116. Ralph Lane
- 117. It ran aground on a sandbar, letting seawater flood the hold and ruin the grain
- 118. Sir Francis Drake
- 119. John White
- 120. CROATOAN

Mastery Tracker

Track your total recall score across all 120 questions.

Attempt	Date	Score (/120)	Parent Validation Stamp	Target for Next Time
1			PARENT VALIDATION STAMP Effort: ★ ★ ★ (Circle 1-3) Date: _____ Signature: _____	
2			PARENT VALIDATION STAMP Effort: ★ ★ ★ (Circle 1-3) Date: _____ Signature: _____	
3			PARENT VALIDATION STAMP Effort: ★ ★ ★ (Circle 1-3) Date: _____ Signature: _____	

Operative Reflection

1. My ultimate strength in this unit is...

2. The three specific facts I need to hunt down and memorize tonight are...

3. Key targets and action steps for the next retrieval attempt:
